

Entrance to mineshaft
Mines were dug in an effort to tunnel under enemy lines and plant explosives, as the British did at nearby Messines in 1917.



Looking down a mineshaft
Two mineshafts 17m (55ft) deep survive at the site. It must have been a soul-destroying job digging them as they would frequently have flooded.



Servicing the trench
The length of timber spanning the trench could serve various purposes, such as carrying telephone wires or rigging a hose to pump out water.

Wicker and sandbags
The wet ground in this sector meant trenches had to be shallow with a built-up parapet of earth-filled sandbags.





Precast concrete
There were originally ten bunkers at Bayernwald, of which two have survived. Built in 1916, most were made of precast concrete blocks brought up to the front by narrow-gauge railway.



Two-room bunker
Inside, each bunker consisted of two rooms with ceilings only 1.2m (4ft) high. A tube through the ceiling could be adapted as a flue for a stove or as a periscope.



Uninviting shelter
The soldiers were allowed to use the bunkers only during heavy artillery bombardment. They were made cramped and uncomfortable for fear men might lose the will to come out and fight.